

Beyond the Books

Renovation of "Walagamba" School Library

Project Report

Beyond the Books.
Beyond the Barriers.

From :
October 15th, 2025

By :
Students of University of Moratuwa

Group 03

Beyond
— THE BOOKS —

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1.PROJECT NEED ASSESSMENT

Benefiting Community	Walagamba Vidyalaya is a small rural school hidden among the misty hills of Dowa village in Bandarawela. For years, the school has served as the central place of learning for children in the surrounding farming community. Most students come from families with limited financial means, and the school remains their primary source of academic and intellectual growth. The library had once been the heart of the school, but over time it had slowly fallen into disrepair. With a broken ceiling, termite-damaged furniture, and barely functional lighting, the space had become more of a storage room than a place of learning. Students rarely entered the library, not because they lacked interest, but because the environment simply did not encourage reading or studying. The project directly benefited: ● Grade 1–11 students of the school ● O/L Mathematics students preparing for the upcoming examinations ● Teachers who lacked resources for teaching ● The rural community that depends on the school for educational support By renovating the library and conducting a Maths workshop, the project aimed to breathe life back into a neglected space and empower students through a combination of environment + learning.
Identified Community Need	During our first visit, the problem became immediately visible. The library looked worn out, with paint peeling off the walls and bookshelves weakened by termites. The single bulb flickered weakly over a room that should have been bright with books and curiosity. We observed several key issues: ● Damaged, unsafe roof ● Insufficient lighting for reading ● Termite-eaten bookshelves and tables ● Dusty and poorly arranged books ● Lack of updated academic material Teachers informed us that although the students were eager to learn, they lacked quiet spaces for study. Many O/L students repeatedly failed Mathematics due to limited access to learning materials and guidance. The school needed not only a renovated library but also educational support, particularly in subjects like Mathematics. This insight motivated us to add a short Maths workshop to help students understand core concepts before their examination season.

Service Opportunity	This project offered us a meaningful opportunity to address two major needs: 1. Educational infrastructure improvement 2. Academic skill development for rural O/L students The library renovation could create a long-term impact by providing: ● A safe environment for reading ● Adequate resources for learning ● A motivational and welcoming space for students The Maths workshop would create immediate, direct benefits by: ● Revisiting important O/L topics ● Clearing student doubts ● Encouraging problem-solving skills ● Boosting confidence before their exams Together, these two components formed a holistic project that uplifted both the mind and the environment. Selected Project and Reason for Selection Our team wanted to select a project that reflected both compassion and practicality. When Walagamba Vidyalaya was proposed, everyone immediately agreed — the school deserved support, and our work could create lasting change. We chose the library renovation for several reasons: ● It impacts every student in the school ● It supports academic excellence in the long run ● It addresses a clear infrastructure need ● It creates an atmosphere that encourages reading and curiosity ● It aligns with the university’s mission of social contribution Adding the O/L Maths session made the project even more meaningful. Instead of only improving physical space, the project also supported the personal academic growth of the students.
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2.PROJECT PROPOSAL

Focused project category	❖ SDG 4 – Quality Education (<i>Primary Focus</i>) Supported by: ● SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities ● SDG 9 – Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure ● SDG 17 – Partnerships for the Goals
Proposed Project Plan	The Walagamba Vidyalaya Library Renovation Project was conceptualized as a community driven initiative aimed at uplifting the educational experience of students in a rural school with limited learning facilities. The project focused on transforming an outdated, deteriorated library space into a vibrant and inspiring learning environment that promotes reading, studying, and academic growth. In addition to the renovation, the project also aimed to support students preparing for the G.C.E. Ordinary Level examination, by conducting a dedicated O/L Mathematics learning session during the opening ceremony. This combined approach strengthened both physical infrastructure and academic development, contributing directly to long-term educational improvement. The project focused on addressing key needs of rural schooling: ● Improved Learning Environment Creating a clean, safe, well-lit and resource-rich library space suitable for daily use. ● Access to Educational Resources Providing updated books, restored furniture, and enhanced library structure. ● Academic Support for Students Conducting an interactive Mathematics session tailored for O/L students. ● Bridging the Rural Education Gap Offering equal learning opportunities for students who often lack access to high-quality educational support. The project highlighted how university students can drive meaningful change by combining their organizational skills, academic knowledge, and community spirit to support rural education and create long-term impact within underserved communities. Idea Generation The idea for the Walagamba Vidyalaya Library Renovation Project emerged during discussions among Group 03 students of the Department of Transport Management & Logistics Engineering, University of Moratuwa. The team sought to undertake a community service initiative that would create tangible, lasting value and directly contribute to improving rural education. While evaluating several possible community outreach ideas, the team identified the deteriorating condition of Walagamba Vidyalaya’s library as a pressing need. A field visit confirmed: ● A broken and unsafe ceiling ● Termite-damaged bookshelves and furniture

- Poor lighting
- Insufficient educational materials
- Lack of a proper reading and study space

Recognizing the impact a well-maintained library could have on students, the concept evolved into a full-scale renovation plan supported by structural improvements, furniture restoration, and book donations.

In addition to renovating the library, teachers informed the team that O/L students faced difficulties in Mathematics due to lack of guidance. Inspired by this need, the team decided to add a **Mathematics workshop** on the opening day — transforming the initiative from a renovation project into a holistic educational development effort.

Drawing from previous community service experiences and inspired by the mission to reduce educational inequality, the project was designed to bring together:

- Infrastructure development
- Student skill-building
- Teacher collaboration
- Community participation

Through this combined focus, the project aimed to empower children in a rural community, enhance their access to quality education, and contribute to their long-term academic success.

Expected Contributions of Organizers to the Project

The organizing team played a vital role throughout the project lifecycle, ensuring smooth execution from planning to completion. Their contributions included:

• Project Coordination

Organizers handled the complete renovation workflow — visiting the school, preparing checklists, allocating responsibilities, coordinating carpenters and painters, monitoring repairs, managing timelines, and ensuring all activities were completed before the opening ceremony.

• Resource Management

The team managed the project budget, sourced materials, restored furniture, and ensured efficient use of funds. Donations were collected, books were categorized, and all equipment, paint, and repair materials were procured under strict budget planning.

• Publicity and Outreach

Organizers communicated with sponsors, supporters, and well-wishers to gather financial and material contributions. Digital posters, social media announcements, and progress updates were used to raise awareness of the project and acknowledge donors.

	• Academic Contribution A well-structured O/L Mathematics workshop was designed and delivered by the team. Organizers prepared lesson materials, selected key topics, planned group activities, and created an interactive learning experience for the students. • Documentation and Reporting Throughout the project, the team captured photographs, recorded progress, maintained financial records, collected feedback, and ensured all documentation was compiled for reporting and evaluation purposes. Through these collective contributions, the organizing team ensured that the Walagamba Vidyalaya Library Renovation Project was not merely a one day event but a meaningful initiative that improved the school's learning environment and empowered students through education. The project stands as a testament to how university students can bring lasting change to rural communities and contribute to national educational development through dedication, teamwork, and compassion.

3.SERVICE CONTEST FORM

Project Title	Project Beyond Books
Project Categories	Community Project focused on, ❖ SDG 4 – Quality Education (<i>Primary Focus</i>) Supported by: • SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities • SDG 9 – Industry, Innovation & Infrastructure • SDG 17 – Partnerships for the Goals
Date	20.10.2025 Note - (We completed all the renovations before 14.10.2025 according to our proposed timeline. However, due to a sudden request from Atlas Axillia, we had to postpone the final ceremony to 20.10.2025.)
Time	11.30 AM
Venue	Walagamba Vidyalaya, Bandarawela
Participants	Mr.Bandara (Atlas area manager - Bandarawela)
Project Chairman	Mr.Ramida Penuka
Project Secretary	Miss Nimasha Rathnayake
Project Treasurer	Mr.Ravindu Shakye
Project Logistics Coordinator	Mr.Samudhitha Damseth

Project Logistics Coordinator	Mr.Thanuja Deemantha
Project Public Relations Coordinator	Mr.Sathira Kaushalya
Project Fund Raising Coordinator	Miss Nayomi Anjalika
Project Publicity Coordinator	Mr.Kajuran
Mode of Fundraised	• Financial Sponsorships • Atlas (Pvt) Ltd - (LKR 100,000) • Globe Link (Pvt) Ltd - (LKR 15,000) • Other Sponsorships ○ Munchee (CBL) - 500 Biscuit packets ○ Jayarathne Hardwares (Pvt) Ltd - Paints and Essential equipment

4.TREASURER REPORT

Estimated Budget

<u>Items</u>	<u>Description</u>	<u>Unit Price</u>	<u>Total</u>
Ceiling			60,000
Partitioning wall			15,000
Paint			12,000
Floor polish			6,500
Equipments			2,000
Sement			6,000
Bug Prevention			3,000
Traveling 1			2,500
Traveling 2			6,000
Total	Total		113,000

Actual Budget

Receipts and Payment Statements

<u>Description</u>	<u>Bill No.</u>	<u>Amount</u>	<u>Amount</u>
<u>Income</u>			
Pen Boxes Selling	-	17,500	
Atlas	12	100,000	
AKW Globe link	13	15,000	
Total			132,500
<u>Expenses</u>			
For Ceiling Advanced	1	80,000	
Ceiling Rest payment 1	2	15,000	
Ceiling Final payment	3	13,000	
Fuel	4	3,000	
Sticker printing for pens	5	2,650	
Electrical equipment from Bandarawela	6	3,070	
Electrical equipment from Pettah	7	6,000	
Sand Papers	8	250	
Bug prevention Chemical	9	400	
Floor paint	10	2,500	
Final Banner on a Board	11	7,000	
Total			132,870
<u>Deficit</u>			(370)

Payment bills and invoices for income & expenses

Bill 1

[illegible]

Bill 2

Transfer to Other Banks	
Cyber Receipt	
Bank Reference Number	0500052693623
Sender's Account Number	80*****37
Sender's Name	MR LIYANA GAMAGE RAMIDA PENUKA
Transfer Amount	15,000.00
Transfer Currency	LKR
Commission	25.00 LKR
Purpose of Payment	Miscellaneous Payments
Beneficiary Name	W B M J C Bandara
Beneficiary Account Number	100600486906
Beneficiary's Account Narration	Ceiling money
Transaction Date/Time	27/09/2025 06:15 PM
Payment Date	27-09-25
Bank/Branch Name	National Savings Bank
Status	Completed
[Cyber Receipt Reference C1F8-3B83-2E38-11B2]	
Generated at 9/27/25 6:15 PM	
Commercial Bank of Ceylon PLC, No 21, Sri Razik Fareed Mawatha (Formerly known as Bristol Street), P.O. Box 856 Colombo 1, Sri Lanka. Tel: +94 11 2353333, email: DigitalBanking@combank.net. All rights reserved.	

Bill 3

Cyber Receipt		Transfer to Other Banks	 COMMERCIAL BANK
Bank Reference Number	O500053292358		
Sender's Account Number	80*****37		
Sender's Name	MR LIYANA GAMAGE RAMIDA PENUKA		
Transfer Amount	13,000.00		
Transfer Currency	LKR		
Commission	25.00 LKR		
Purpose of Payment	Miscellaneous Payments		
Beneficiary Name	W B M J C Bandara		
Beneficiary Account Number	100600486906		
Beneficiary's Account Narration	Ceiling		
Transaction Date/Time	30/09/2025 02:48 PM		
Payment Date	30-09-25		
Bank/Branch Name	National Savings Bank		
Status	Completed		

[Cyber Receipt Reference BA59-F057-6C20-F86E]

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Commercial Bank of Ceylon PLC, No 21, Sri Razik Fareed Mawatha (Formerly known as Bristol Street), P.O. Box 856 Colombo 1, Sri Lanka. Tel: +94 11 2353353, email: DigitalBanking@combank.net, All rights reserved

Bill 4

Property of HNB valid only for HNB POS machines

HNB
HNB BANK LTD. KATHMANDU

W. M. WICKRAMASEKERA BUILDINGS,
NO. 19 A,
HURANA, COLOMBO ROAD,
P.O. BOX 50711

TX TIME 000000090918 07/16/2008
MERCHANT ID:9170108700
ORIGINAL ID:93695130
AUTH ACN 1000307
AUTH ID 0003361

SALE

PROD NAME 00000000000000000000
EXP DATE 00000000000000000000
CARD TYPE AMERICAN EXPRESS
ID A0000000025010402
C NUMBER 16165669681808318
EXP CODE 037613
PROD NUM 1026102BB7807

AMOUNT: LKR: 3,000.00

Property of HNB valid o

** NO SIGNATURE REQUIRED **
** NO PIN REQUIRED **

JANAPRIYA/ANANDA
I AGREE TO PAY THE ABOVE TOTAL AMOUNT
ACCORDING TO THE CARD USER AGREEMENT
***** CUSTOMER COPY *****

HNB Card Centre - No

Bill 9



Bill 10

Lalith Hardware - Kesbewa
0723878417

INVOICE

00600072K

Bill To:
Ramida

Date: Oct 5, 2025

Balance Due: LKR 0.00

Item	Quantity	Rate	Amount
Nippon Floor Paint (Q/D)	1	LKR 2,500.00	LKR 2,500.00

Subtotal: LKR 2,500.00

Tax (0%): LKR 0.00

Total: LKR 2,500.00

Amount Paid: LKR 2,500.00

Bill 11

Declaration of Payment Without Supporting Bill

Date: 30/09/2025

Dear Treasurer,

This is to inform you that a payment was made for the Final Banner with the Board cost to Hiru Prints, Kafubedda at the project Beyond the Books held on 19/10/2025

The total amount paid was Rs. 7000

As no official bill or receipt was issued for this transaction, I hereby declare that the information provided above is true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

Thank you.

Yours faithfully,

(Signature)

Name: Ramida Penuka

Position: Project Leader

Acknowledgement of Receipt

I confirm that I have received the above-mentioned payment.

(Signature)

Name of Receiver: Ramida Penuka

Contact No.: 0769947326

NIC No.: 200316200282

Bill 12 (income)



Advice sending date: 11 Oct 2025
Advice reference no: A2m1m3UdzHVe
Page: 1/1

Payment Advice

Recipient's name and contact information:

Society of Transport & Logistics University of Moratuwa
HSBCAdvice@atlasaxillia.com

Transaction type: ACH credits

Beneficiary's name:	SOCIETY TRANSPORT	Remittance amount:	LKR100,000.00
Beneficiary's bank:	BANK OF CEYLON	Value date:	10 OCT 2025
	Sri Lanka	Beneficiary's name:	ATLAS AXILLIA COMPANY PVT LTD
Beneficiary's account:	72***** (Part of the account number is shown as ***** for security reasons.)	Remitting bank:	HK and Shanghai Banking Corp Ltd
Customer reference:	2025010AF288	Instruction reference:	9001ZJALFDQ7
2nd party reference:	2000543147		

Remitter to beneficiary information:

Document Number	Amount	Date	Reference Type
1900098647	LKR 100000.00	01/10/2025	MEMO-011025

Bill 13 (income)



ComBank Q⁺ Digital Receipt

Reference ID	527403264122
Date	Wed Oct 1 2025 08:40
Recipient's Bank	Bank of Ceylon
Account No	XXX2815
Bill Amount	15,000.00LKR
Transaction Fee	25.00LKR
Transaction Status	Success
Purpose	Other Financial Activity
Transferred From	476673XXXXXX6101

This is computer generated document. No signature is required.
Should you require further assistance,
please call our 24/7 Call Centre +94 11 2353353 or
email to gplus@combank.net

Thank you for banking with us.
ComBank O⁺ Team

5.Supporting Documents

Approval Letter from “Walagamba” School

L.G.R.Penuka,
University of Moratuwa.
0769947326

Date: 07/08/2025

The Principal,
B/Walagambha Vidyalyaya,
Dowa,
Badulla Road,
Bandarawela.

Dear Sir,

Subject: Request for Approval to Renovate the School Library as a Community Project

I hope this letter finds you well.

We are a group of students from University of Moratuwa, currently following the *Essential Skills Development – Community Development Project* module. As part of this module, we are required to carry out a small-scale project that will help a community in need.

As part of this project, we are hoping to support your school by making some improvements that will benefit the students and the learning environment. We have selected your school because we believe it will be a meaningful opportunity for us to make a positive impact.

This work will be done free of charge by our team. We hope this will help create a better learning space for your students.

We kindly request your approval to carry out this project. Please let us know if we have your permission and if there are any specific guidelines we need to follow.

Thank you for your time and support. We are looking forward to working together for the benefit of your school.

Yours sincerely,

L.G.R.Penuka,
On behalf of the Project Group,
Department of Transport Management & Logistics Engineering,
Faculty of Engineering,
University of Moratuwa.

Mr. L. G. P. Remota - The Project
It is with pleasure we would
like to accept and approve
the CSR project suggested with
heartfelt wish.

Principal
N.W.B. Lasath de Silva
S/PS - MED, PGDEM,
B/Valagamba Vidyalaya
Dova, Bandarawela

11/05/2025

N.W.B. Lasath de Silva
Principal
SLPS I- Med, PGDEM,
B/Walagamba Vidyalaya
Dova, Bandarawela

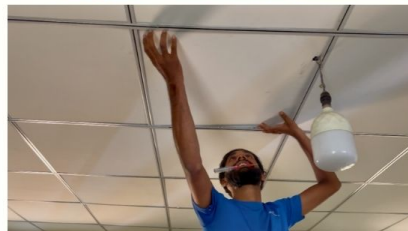
Before



After



A glimpse of our project during the implementation phase



During the WorkShop process for the grade 11 students



Providing biscuits for the every student of the school with a cool drink



Meet the Team



Ramida Penuka
231455L
Chair Person



Nimasha Rathnayake
231460X
Secretary



Ravindu Shakye
231480H
Treasurer



Samuditha Damseth
231417A
Logistics



Thanuja Deemantha
231415P
Logistics



Sathira Kaushalya
231444D
Public Relations



Nayomi Anjalika
231404G
Fund Raising Coordinator



Kajuran
231442U
Publicity Coordinator